

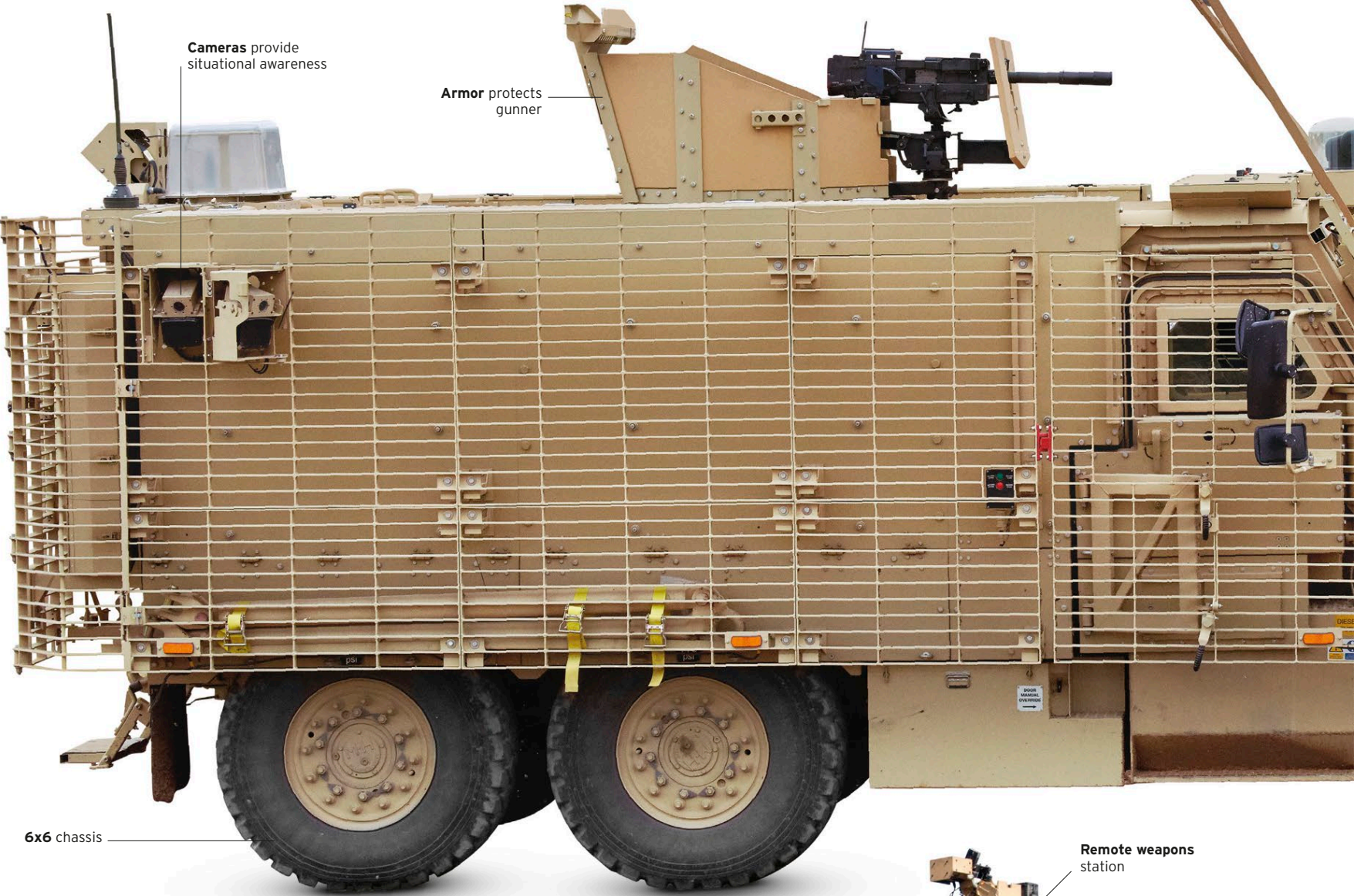
Counterinsurgency Vehicles (cont.)

Political considerations often restricted the types of vehicles that could be used in counterinsurgency operations to lighter wheeled vehicles, which were often equipped with extra armor. The South African Border War of the 1980s saw the development of vehicles that protected against both mines and direct fire. When the Improvised Explosive Device (IED) threat began to arise in Iraq and Afghanistan during the 21st century, these designs formed the starting point for the American Mine-Resistant Ambush Protected (MRAP) vehicle program.



△ Buffalo
Date 2002 Country USA
Weight 38.1 tons (34.5 tonnes)
Engine Caterpillar C13 Diesel, 440 hp
Main armament None

Designed to carry EOD personnel, the Buffalo is significantly longer and taller than other MRAPs. It is equipped with a 33 ft (10 m) articulated manipulator arm that can be used to uncover and disable IEDs. The Buffalo is also used by British, Canadian, French, Italian, and Pakistani forces.



Cameras provide situational awareness

Armor protects gunner

6x6 chassis

Remote weapons station

△ Mastiff
Date 2002 Country UK
Weight 26 tons (23.6 tonnes)
Engine Caterpillar C7 diesel, 330 hp
Main armament .50 Browning M2 machine gun

The Mastiff is the British Army's version of the Force Protection Cougar MRAP, which saved thousands of lives in Iraq and Afghanistan. Unlike Cougar, the Mastiff has armor plate instead of armored side windows, and is equipped with bar armor.

▷ Bushmaster
Date 2003 Country Australia
Weight 17 tons (15.4 tonnes)
Engine Caterpillar 3126E diesel, 300 hp
Main armament Varies

The Bushmaster was designed to provide protected mobility for a nine-man infantry section over long distances. Its armor and mine protection made it popular in Iraq and Afghanistan. Australia has ordered over 1,000 variants, including command, mortar, ambulance, air defense, and route clearance.

